

THE BUSINESS MATURITY MODEL

Stage 8

Division

You've got a few hundred people and you're still trying to keep your hands on all of it. Nobody knows everything, and the business has outgrown one person's reach.

100-249 PEOPLE · \$75M-\$150M REVENUE

You are here.

Every business climbs the same ten stages, set by how many people you've got and how much you make. You're at **Division**. Here's what that means, across your whole business.

0	Foundation	Just you · Pre-revenue
1	Validation	Just you · Under \$100K
2	Traction	You + vendors · \$100K-\$500K
3	Structure	2-4 people · \$500K-\$1M
4	Focus	5-9 people · \$1M-\$3M
5	Expansion	10-19 people · \$3M-\$10M
6	Efficiency	20-49 people · \$10M-\$30M
7	Systems	50-99 people · \$30M-\$75M
8	Division YOU ARE HERE	100-249 people · \$75M-\$150M
9	Reinvention	250-500 people · \$150M+

Stage 8: Division

WHO

100-249 people, four layers deep. You run a team of teams now.

THE CONSTRAINT

You're spread across more products and markets than one person can know well.

GRADUATE BY

Build dedicated specialist teams and prune. Fewer things, done deeper, owned by people you trust.

THE BIG PICTURE

You built systems in the last stage so the place stopped feeling like chaos. It worked. Now you've got a few hundred people across products, markets, and departments, and a different problem shows up. The business knows more than any one person can hold. You used to keep tabs on everything that mattered. You can't anymore, and trying to is what's slowing you down.

Growth you don't control will hurt you here. The more you add without pruning, the more the business sprawls into things it's only average at. Each extra product and market dilutes what made you good. The companies that break through this stage hire specialists who go deeper than you could, and they cut what isn't earning its place.

This stage comes down to letting go on purpose. Put specialists on each part of the business, give them room to own it, and prune everything else. Here's what that looks like across every part of your business.

The stage comes down to two moves: put specialists deep on each part of the business, and prune what you're only decent at. The next pages run both across all three engines of your business.

Across your business.

Every business runs on three engines. Eight parts sit inside them. At Division, one part is straining each engine right now. Those three are marked Start here. Get them right and the rest follows.

SALES & MARKETING

Marketing

Creative got broad to cover everything, so the leads come in lower quality and the brand blurs.

Sales

START HERE

Your premium-closing efficiency is dropping because the team's flat. Everyone gets the same leads and the same coaching, so your best people aren't aimed at your best deals and your weak spots stay hidden. *metrics-driven coaching · The Sales Acceleration Formula promote from within · The Sales Acceleration Formula*

OPERATIONS

Product & service

START HERE

You said yes to too much, so the product sprawled. Overwhelm is the number-one reason customers leave, and you're piling on more of it. *The Hedgehog Concept · Good to Great pruning and simplicity · The Essential Drucker*

Customer service

Different customers need different journeys, and yours collide or land at the wrong time.

Technology

Departments have outgrown the general software everyone shared.

FINANCE & ADMIN

Finance

START HERE

Scale made you sloppy with money. You're paying retail on contracts you never reshopped, cash sits idle, and at this size nobody's checking the spending closely enough to catch waste. *internal audits and reshopping vendors · Simple Numbers economic value and self-funding · Simple Numbers*

Hiring

Different recruiters hold different bars, so the people coming in are uneven and the culture pays for it.

Your people

Performance slips under the sheer volume of people, and complaints and compliance issues climb.

Start here.

The one part breaking each engine. Get these right and the rest of the stage gets easier. Each names the tell, what to do, and the book behind it.

Sales SALES & MARKETING

Your best closer and your newest rep get handed the same leads off the same pile.

THE CONSTRAINT

Your premium-closing efficiency is dropping because the team's flat. Everyone gets the same leads and the same coaching, so your best people aren't aimed at your best deals and your weak spots stay hidden.

DO THIS

Route the best leads to the best closers, and split the floor into specialists by product and by deal size. Track the numbers granular, by rep and by product, so a bad ratio points at one skill in one person you can coach. Coach that skill, then check next month whether it moved. Grow your next sales leaders off your own bench.

SOURCE metrics-driven coaching · *The Sales Acceleration Formula*, Mark Roberge

SOURCE promote from within · *The Sales Acceleration Formula*, Mark Roberge

Product & service OPERATIONS

You keep shipping features, and the more you ship the more people cancel.

THE CONSTRAINT

You said yes to too much, so the product sprawled. Overwhelm is the number-one reason customers leave, and you're piling on more of it.

DO THIS

Prune to what you're best at. Survey your customers, cut the features almost nobody uses, and let go of the markets and lines you're only average in. Collins calls it the Hedgehog. Be the best in the world at one thing. The features you cut don't vanish. The strong ones come back as add-ons and cross-sells.

SOURCE The Hedgehog Concept · *Good to Great*, Jim Collins

SOURCE pruning and simplicity · *The Essential Drucker*, Peter Drucker

Finance FINANCE & ADMIN

You're still paying the rates you signed years ago, and cash is sitting in checking earning nothing.

THE CONSTRAINT

Scale made you sloppy with money. You're paying retail on contracts you never reshopped, cash sits idle, and at this size nobody's checking the spending closely enough to catch waste.

BENCHMARK

Healthy here is steady double-digit pretax profit, funded by equity you built rather than debt you took on. To read what the business is worth, take the last three years of pretax profit plus the equity built up inside it.

DO THIS

Renegotiate everything. Run an expense cleanse, reshop every major vendor, and move idle cash to yield. Bring tax in-house with a specialist and stand up internal audits to catch waste. Fund growth with your own retained profit before you ever reach for debt, because your own money earns 40 to 70% back and makes you careful with it. You still read the P&L every month, with notes.

SOURCE internal audits and reshopping vendors · *Simple Numbers*, Greg Crabtree

SOURCE economic value and self-funding · *Simple Numbers*, Greg Crabtree

The rest of your business.

Not the three to start with, but they're in play at this stage. Here's the move on each, for when you're ready.

SALES & MARKETING

Marketing

Creative got broad to cover everything, so the leads come in lower quality and the brand blurs.

DO THIS

Tighten the message back to a one-to-three-word association and say it a hundred ways. Put free value out front. The broader you got, the more the wrong people raised their hands.

OPERATIONS

Customer service

Different customers need different journeys, and yours collide or land at the wrong time.

DO THIS

Split the journey by who the customer is. Separate onboarding, sequencing, and segments, and put proactive cross-sell where it fits. Spend your service muscle on your highest-value customers and cut the journeys that cost more than they return.

Technology

Departments have outgrown the general software everyone shared.

DO THIS

Let each department run the specialized stack it needs, and stand up internal ticketing with response times so nothing gets dropped. Decentralize the tools, keep the data connected.

FINANCE & ADMIN

Hiring

Different recruiters hold different bars, so the people coming in are uneven and the culture pays for it.

DO THIS

Standardize how you select. Structured interviews, a panel where each person owns a role, and a one-to-five score on both skill and values. Keep an owner fit-check on the final call so the bar holds across every team.

Your people

Performance slips under the sheer volume of people, and complaints and compliance issues climb.

DO THIS

Build the systems behind your people. Group onboarding, documented performance management, leadership and development training, and the right insurance for an employer this size. Keep reinforcing the values, because they're what hold a few hundred people together.

Where you stand.

ON TRACK

- Each part of the business has a specialist who knows it deeper than you
- You've pruned products, markets, or features in the last year
- Your best closers get your best leads
- You've reshopped your vendors and your cash earns a return
- You still read the P&L every month with your own notes

STILL NEED WORK

- You're still trying to keep your hands on everything
- You keep adding products and markets without cutting any
- Every rep gets the same leads off the same pile
- You're paying rates you haven't looked at in years
- Cash sits in checking doing nothing

Graduating to Stage 9. You'll know you're ready when the business runs on specialists who go deeper than you can, you've pruned hard, and the money's tight and working. The next stage is about the big bet: where the whole company goes when the core can't grow much further.

Want the numbers behind a business this size?

Subscribe to the newsletter. I break down the financial moves that protect a company at scale, in plain language, one idea at a time.

BUILT ON

This stage draws on **Good to Great** (Jim Collins), **The Essential Drucker** (Peter Drucker), **The Sales Acceleration Formula** (Mark Roberge), and **Simple Numbers** (Greg Crabtree). The moves are ours. The thinking stands on theirs.